Digital Decision-Making: A Survey on Interface Design and Choices

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Eligibility: University students aged 18 and above who regularly make digital decisions (e.g., online purchases, app permissions, subscriptions).

Purpose: A course research project investigating how digital interfaces affect choices. The full aims and mechanics of the study will be explained in a debriefing screen after you submit.

Procedure: One online simulated experiment featuring three short tasks (shopping comparison, app permissions, and an auto-renewing subscription), followed by a brief questionnaire. Takes about 5-10 minutes.

Voluntariness: Taking part is completely voluntary. You may skip any question, or stop at any time by closing this page without penalty. Nothing is saved until you submit.

Risks: Minimal. All product, price, and permission scenarios are completely simulated. No real purchases, payments, or personal data are collected.

Confidentiality: Your responses are anonymous. We do not ask for your name, and data is securely stored using anonymous participant IDs rather than identifiable information.

Withdrawal: Because this study involves simulated interfaces, you will be fully debriefed on the study's true purpose at the end and given the immediate option to withdraw your data. To remove your response after submitting, note the withdrawal code below and email it to abhigyan24018@iiitd.ac.in - we will delete the matching response.

* Indicates required question

1. Consent *

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ I confirm I am 18 or above and currently enrolled at a university, and I consent to take part
- ◯ I do not meet these criteria, or I do not consent

Task 1 - Shopping (Consumer Price & Value Comparison)

Please answer the following questions based on the wireless headphones scenario you just completed.

2. Recall: What was the price of the headphones that featured Active Noise Cancellation (Product B)?

Mark only one oval.

- ₹1,499
- ₹1,999
- ₹2,499
- ₹2,999

3. Consequence: If you chose the cheapest option (Product A at ₹1,499), what specific trade-off were you making compared to the other options?

Mark only one oval.

- Shorter warranty (6 months) and lower battery life (20 hours)
- No noise cancellation but longer battery life (35 hours)
- Higher price for better sound quality
- There were no trade-offs; all products had the same warranty

4. Confidence: How confident are you that you made the best possible choice for this task? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely confident

5. Frustration: How frustrated did you feel while completing this digital decision?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely frustrated

Task 2 - Privacy (App Permission Decision)

Please answer the following questions based on the FitLife app permissions scenario you just completed.

6. Recall: Which of the following data permissions was explicitly requested by the FitLife app?

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ Microphone and Camera access
- ◯ Location (including background) and Contacts
- ◯ Photo gallery and social media accounts
- ◯ Biometric and fingerprint data

7. Consequence: According to the privacy disclosure on the screen, what is a potential consequence of granting permissions to the app?

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ Your personal information may be shared with third-party service providers.
- ◯ Your data is encrypted and permanently locked to your device.
- ◯ Your account will automatically upgrade to a paid version.
- ◯ Your device's battery life will drain 50% faster.

8. Confidence: How confident are you that you made the best possible choice for this task?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely confident

9. Frustration: How frustrated did you feel while completing this digital decision?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely frustrated

Task 3 - Subscription (Auto-Renewal Decision)

Please answer the following questions based on the Premium Membership scenario you just completed.

10. Recall: What is the regular monthly price of the Premium Membership after the introductory period ends?

Mark only one oval.

- ₹99/month
- ₹299/month
- ₹499/month
- It remains free forever

11. Consequence: If you selected "Start Introductory Offer" for ₹99, what action is required to avoid being charged the regular price next month?

Mark only one oval.

- No action is needed; the subscription cancels automatically.
- You must email customer support within 30 days.
- You must manually cancel through account settings before the next billing date.
- You simply need to delete the application from your device.

12. Confidence: How confident are you that you made the best possible choice for this task?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely confident

13. Frustration: How frustrated did you feel while completing this digital decision?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely frustrated

Post-Study Questionnaire

Thank you for completing the scenarios. Please answer these final questions about your experience and general habits.

14. Decision Regret: Thinking back on the three choices you just made, how much regret do you feel about your final decisions? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
No r	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	High regret

15. Rushed Decisions: Did you feel rushed while making any of the decisions during this experiment? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Stro	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Strongly Agree

16. E-commerce Frequency: How often do you engage in digital transactions (e.g., online shopping, subscribing to services, downloading new apps)? *

Mark only one oval.

- Daily
- Several times a week
- A few times a month
- Rarely or never

17. Impulsive Clicking Habits: In your daily life, how often do you click "Buy Now", "Accept", or "Subscribe" without fully reading the terms or comparing options?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
Nev	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Always

18. Prior Preferences: Before starting these tasks, did you have a strong personal preference to prioritize saving money and protecting privacy over speed and convenience? *

Mark only one oval.

- Yes
- No
- Unsure

19. General Feedback: Do you have any additional thoughts on the interface or the decisions you had to make?

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